

DIPOLE TYPE BY LENGTH

l = antenna rod length (m)

λ (wavelength) = $\frac{c}{f} = \frac{3 \times 10^8}{f}$ (m)		
l/λ	Type	Use formula
< 1/50	Hertzian (short)	HERTZIAN $S(R, \theta)$, $D=1.5$
= 1/4	Quarter-wave	ARB formula, $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/4$
= 1/2	Half-wave	half-wave shortcut, $D=1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}}=73\ \Omega$
= 1	Full-wave	ARB, $D=2.41$, $R_{\text{rad}}=199\ \Omega$
other	Arbitrary	ARB formula

HERTZIAN DIPOLE — $S(R, \theta)$

Far-field E,H phasors $l \ll \lambda$ $\vec{E}_\theta = \frac{jI_0 k l \eta_0}{4\pi R} \frac{e^{-jkR}}{R} \sin \theta$, $\vec{H}_\phi = \vec{E}_\theta / \eta_0$ Avg power density $l/\lambda < 1/50$; far field	
$S(R, \theta) = \frac{\eta_0 k^2 I_0^2 l^2}{32\pi^2 R^2} \sin^2 \theta$ (W/m ²)	
<i>Equivalent:</i> $S = S_{\text{max}} \sin^2 \theta$ with $S_{\text{max}} = \eta_0 k^2 I_0^2 l^2 / (32\pi^2 R^2)$ at $\theta = \pi/2$.	
l : rod length (m)	I_0 : peak current (A)
R : obs. distance (m)	θ : angle from dipole axis (rad)
$k = 2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m)	$\eta_0 = 120\pi \approx 377\ \Omega$
Total radiated power $P_{\text{rad}} = \frac{\eta_0 \pi}{3} (I_0 l / \lambda)^2$ (W)	

ARBITRARY-LENGTH DIPOLE — $S(\theta)$

Power density at R any l $S(\theta) = \frac{15 I_0^2}{\pi R^2} \left[\frac{\cos(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda} \cos \theta) - \cos(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda})}{\sin \theta} \right]^2$	
<i>At $\theta = 0, \pi$: bracket is 0/0. L'Hôpital $\Rightarrow S = 0$ (no axial radiation). TI-36X alt: evaluate bracket at $\theta = 0.001$ rad $\rightarrow$ tiny $\rightarrow 0$.</i>	
Normalized pattern dimensionless $F(\theta) = S(\theta) / S_{\text{max}}$	

COMMON ANGLES (deg $\leftrightarrow$ rad, trig values)

Conversion multiply by $\pi/180$ or $180/\pi$ $\theta_{\text{rad}} = \theta_{\text{deg}} \cdot \frac{\pi}{180}$ $\theta_{\text{deg}} = \theta_{\text{rad}} \cdot \frac{180}{\pi}$	
$^\circ$	rad
$\sin \theta$	$\cos \theta$
$\sin^2 \theta$	$\cos^2 \theta$
0	0
0	0
0	0
1	0
1	0
1	0
30	$\pi/6$
1/2	$\sqrt{3}/2$
1/4	3/4
45	$\pi/4$
$\sqrt{2}/2$	$\sqrt{2}/2$
1/2	1/2
1/2	1/2
60	$\pi/3$
$\sqrt{3}/2$	3/4
1/4	1/4
90	$\pi/2$
1	0
0	1
180	π
0	-1
0	1

Antenna formulas usually take θ in rad. RAD mode on calc.

LINEAR ANTENNA ARRAY

Array factor (uniform, broadside) $k = 2\pi/\lambda$, $\gamma = kd \cos \theta$ $F_a(\theta) = \frac{\sin^2(N\gamma/2)}{\sin^2(\gamma/2)}$; $F_a^{\text{max}} = N^2$ at $\theta = \pi/2$	
Normalize $F_a^{\text{norm}} = F_a / N^2$	
HPBW (broadside, uniform) use Nd, not $(N-1)d$ $\beta \approx 0.88 \frac{\lambda}{Nd}$ (rad) = $50.8^\circ \cdot \frac{\lambda}{Nd}$	
Electronic steering (scan to θ_0) replace γ with $\gamma' = kd(\cos \theta - \cos \theta_0)$	
$\delta = \frac{2\pi d}{\lambda} \cos \theta_0$ ($\frac{\text{rad}}{\text{elt}}$); $\theta_0 = \frac{\pi}{2}$: broadside, 0: end-fire	
Frequency scan feed-line incr. $\Delta \ell = n_0 \lambda_0$ $\cos \theta_0 \approx \frac{n_0 \lambda_0}{d} \frac{\Delta f}{f_0}$	
<i>Grating lobes appear if $d > \lambda$. Avoid.</i>	

BEAM PARAMETERS — β , Ω_p , D

Normalize always start here $F(\theta) = S(\theta) / S_{\text{max}}$ (unitless) Beamwidth β at threshold X Set $F(\theta_X) = X$, solve for θ_X ; $\beta = 2\theta_X$ (symmetric)		
Threshold	$X = 10\text{dB}/10$	θ_X
HPBW (−3 dB)	0.5	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 2}{a}}$
−6 dB	0.25	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 4}{a}}$
−10 dB	0.1	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 10}{a}}$
any $F(\theta_X)$	any X	$F(\theta_X) = X$
Pattern solid angle Ω_p recognize pattern, look up $\Omega_p = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta \, d\theta \, d\phi$ (sr) <i>No ϕ dep.: $\Omega_p = 2\pi \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta \, d\theta$.</i> <i>$\theta$ is the integration variable — DON'T plug in a number for θ (e.g. $\theta_{1/2}$). Integrate over $\theta \in [0, \pi]$.</i>		
Pattern $F(\theta)$	Ω_p (sr)	
Isotropic ($F=1$)	$4\pi \approx 12.57$	
Hertzian $\sin^2 \theta$	$8\pi/3 \approx 8.38$	
Half-wave dipole	≈ 7.66	
Narrow Gauss $e^{-a\theta^2}$	$\pi/a = \pi\theta_{1/2}^2 / \ln 2$	
2-axis HPBW (aperture)	$\beta_{xz} \cdot \beta_{yz}$	
Other (use integral)	numerical	

TI-36X: [2nd] [d/dx] for $\int \square$, RAD mode, multiply by 2π .

Directivity D always $D = 4\pi/\Omega_p$; common shortcuts below $D = \frac{4\pi}{\Omega_p}$ (unitless) $D_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} D$		
WORD TRAP: “direction” = θ_{max} (rad); “directivity” = D (unitless).		
Gain (if asked) ξ = radiation efficiency (unitless), $0 < \xi \leq 1$ $G = \xi D$ (unitless) $G_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} G$ (dB)		
Lossless / ideal antenna $\Rightarrow G = D$.		
$\xi = \frac{R_{\text{rad}}}{R_{\text{rad}} + R_{\text{loss}}} = \frac{P_{\text{rad}}}{P_{\text{rad}} + P_{\text{loss}}}$; $R_{\text{rad}} = 2P_{\text{rad}}/I_0^2$ (Ω); $R_{\text{in}} = R_{\text{rad}} + R_{\text{loss}}$.		

COMMON DIPOLE PARAMETERS

Lossless ($\xi=1$): $G=D$.				
Type	l	D	D_{dB}	R_{rad} (Ω)
Isotropic	N/A	1	0	—
Hertzian	$< \lambda/50$	1.5	1.76	$80\pi^2(l/\lambda)^2$
Half-wave	$\lambda/2$	1.64	2.15	73.2
Monopole	$\lambda/4$ (gnd)	1.64	2.15	36.6
Full-wave	λ	2.41	3.82	199
Half-wave: $P_{\text{rad}} = 36.6 I_0^2$ W. Monopole ($\lambda/4$ above ground): same patt. as half-wave but P_{rad} , R_{rad} halved.				

ANTENNA AREAS (A_e , A_p)

Effective area antenna's RX cross section; D from BEAM PARAMS or table above $A_e = \frac{\lambda^2 D}{4\pi}$ (m ²)	
Physical cross section wire dipole, diameter d; l see table above $A_p = l d$ (m ² , any dipole)	
Inverse: D from A_e $D = \frac{4\pi A_e}{\lambda^2}$ (unitless)	
<i>Thin wire:</i> $A_e \gg A_p$ (e.g., Hertzian $A_e = 3\lambda^2/8\pi \approx 0.119\lambda^2$).	

FRISIS TRANSMISSION FORMULA

<i>For each antenna's G: if given by NAME (“half-wave dipole” etc.) $\rightarrow$ COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS ($G=D$, lossless). Else (dB/linear value given) $\rightarrow$ use as given (convert dB $\rightarrow$ linear).</i>	
Pwr density at RX, then RX pwr G_t, G_r linear gains; $\lambda = c/f$ $S_r = \frac{G_t P_t}{4\pi R^2}$ (W/m ²); $P_r = G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi R}\right)^2 P_t$ (W)	
Equivalent: $P_r = S_r A_{e,r}$.	
Solve for R max range $R = \frac{\lambda}{4\pi} \sqrt{\frac{G_t G_r P_t}{P_r}}$ (m)	
Equivalent form using A_e recv. area form $P_r = \frac{G_t P_t A_{e,r}}{4\pi R^2}$, $G_r = \frac{4\pi A_{e,r}}{\lambda^2}$	
Free-space path loss: $L_{fs} = (4\pi R/\lambda)^2$, so $P_r = G_t G_r P_t / L_{fs}$.	
Off-axis (patterns not aligned): multiply by $F_t(\theta_t, \phi_t) F_r(\theta_r, \phi_r)$, both = 1 when aligned.	
Recipe 1. $\lambda = c/f$. 2. Convert any dB gain $\rightarrow$ linear: $G = 10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$.	
3. Get G_t, G_r by antenna type: dipole $\rightarrow$ COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS; aperture $\rightarrow$ APERTURE box; arbitrary $F \rightarrow$ BEAM PARAMS. 4. Plug into Friis.	
<i>Use linear G, not dB. Convert FIRST.</i>	

dB $\leftrightarrow$ LINEAR

Works for any power-like quantity ($G, D, P_r/P_t, \text{SNR}, \dots$): $X_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} X_{\text{lin}}$ $X_{\text{lin}} = 10^{X_{\text{dB}}/10}$ Memorize: 3 dB $\Leftrightarrow \times 2$, 10 dB $\Leftrightarrow \times 10$. Add dB = multiply linear.	
<i>For E-field / amplitude use 20 log not 10 log (power $\propto E^2$).</i>	

NOISE & SNR

Noise power thermal noise into matched receiver $P_N = k_B T_{\text{sys}} B$ (W)	
$k_B = 1.38 \times 10^{-23}$ J/K; T_{sys} system noise temp (K); B receiver bandwidth (Hz).	
Signal-to-noise ratio $\text{SNR} = \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$ (unitless) $\text{SNR}_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$	

APERTURE ANTENNAS (horn, dish)

A_p physical aperture area (m ²); A_e effective area (m ² , = $\lambda^2 D/4\pi$); β_{xz}, β_{yz} HPBW's in two planes (rad); ℓ, d aperture side / diameter (m).			
<i>Far-field req.: $R \geq 2d^2/\lambda$ (d = largest aperture dim.).</i>			
Pattern (rect., uniform illum.) peak at $\theta = 0$ (broadside) $F(\theta) = \text{sinc}^2\left(\frac{\pi \ell_x \sin \theta}{\lambda}\right)$; $S_0 = \frac{E_0^2 A_p^2}{2\eta_0 \lambda^2 R^2}$			
Directivity (any shape, uniform illum.) $D \approx \frac{4\pi A_p}{\lambda^2}$ (unitless) $\Rightarrow A_e \approx A_p$			
Directivity from beamwidths any aperture $D \approx \frac{4\pi}{\beta_{xz} \beta_{yz}}$ (use rad); circular: $D \approx 4\pi/\beta^2$			
HPBW and D by aperture shape uniform illum.; β in rad			
Shape	A_p	HPBW (rad)	D (unitless)
Rect. $\ell_x \times \ell_y$		$\beta_x \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell_x$ $\beta_y \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell_y$	$D \approx 4\pi/(\beta_x \beta_y)$ $= 4\pi \ell_x \ell_y / \lambda^2$
Square ℓ	ℓ^2	$\beta \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell$	$D \approx 4\pi/\beta^2 = 4\pi \ell^2 / \lambda^2$
Circular (diam. d)	$\pi d^2/4$	$\beta \approx 1.02\lambda/d$	$D \approx 4\pi/\beta^2 = \pi^2 d^2 / \lambda^2$
Scaling (any ratio) $D \propto A_p/\lambda^2$; $\beta \propto \lambda/\sqrt{A_p}$ $D_{\text{new}} = D_{\text{old}} \cdot \frac{A_{p,\text{new}}}{A_{p,\text{old}}} \cdot \left(\frac{f_{\text{new}}}{f_{\text{old}}}\right)^2$ $\beta_{\text{new}} = \beta_{\text{old}} \cdot \sqrt{\frac{A_{p,\text{old}}}{A_{p,\text{new}}}} \cdot \frac{f_{\text{old}}}{f_{\text{new}}}$ <i>If a parameter is unchanged, its ratio = 1. Examples: double area $\rightarrow D \times 2$, $\beta \times 1/\sqrt{2}$; double freq $\rightarrow D \times 4$, $\beta \times 1/2$.</i>			

DIPOLE

l — antenna length (m) $\lambda = c/f$ (m); $c = 3 \times 10^8$ m/s I_0 — peak current (A) $k = 2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m) R — obs. dist. (m); θ from axis $\eta_0 = 120\pi \approx 377\ \Omega$ $S(R, \theta)$ — pwr density (W/m ²)

BEAM

$F(\theta) = S/S_{\text{max}}$ (unitless) a — coef. on θ^2 in Gaussian β — HPBW (rad or $^\circ$) Ω_p — pattern solid angle (sr) $D = 4\pi/\Omega_p$ — directivity ξ radiation eff. (unitless); $G = \xi D$ $D_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} D$; $D = 10^{D_{\text{dB}}/10}$

FRISIS / dB

P_t — power transmitted (W) P_r — power received (W) G_t — transmit gain (linear) G_r — receive gain (linear) $S_r = G_t P_t / (4\pi R^2)$ (W/m ²) $P_r = G_t G_r (\lambda/4\pi R)^2 P_t$ $G = 10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$ 3 dB = $\times 2$, 10 dB = $\times 10$ $P_N = k_B T_{\text{sys}} B$ (W)
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APERTURE

A_p — physical area (m ²) $A_e = \lambda^2 D / (4\pi)$ (m ²) $A_e \approx A_p$ for aperture $D \approx 4\pi A_p / \lambda^2$ (unitless) $\beta \approx 0.88\lambda/\ell$ (rect/sq.) $\beta \approx 1.02\lambda/d$ (circular) $2A_p \Rightarrow 2D, \beta/\sqrt{2}$
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ARRAY

N — number of elements d — spacing (m) $\gamma = kd \cos \theta$ $F_a = \sin^2(N\gamma/2) / \sin^2(\gamma/2)$ $F_a^{\text{max}} = N^2$ at $\theta = \pi/2$ $F_a^{\text{norm}} = F_a / N^2$ $\beta \approx 0.88\lambda/(Nd)$ (broadside)
